

The Ghana staff will scan each form to preserve the electronic image and retain the original hardcopy form in their archives. This scanning process retains only the photo image of each form but does not extract the information recorded onto the form. Each data collection form will be keyed twice in Ghana by two different data entry staff into the Data Entry and Management System. The resultant data files and scanned images will be managed by this system and automatically transferred to Westat on a regular basis. Please see Chapter 16 for more detail about this system.

Westat staff will programmatically compare each pair of data files and resolve data entry discrepancies by examining the scanned images. Any data entry errors that can be corrected based on review of the images will be implemented at Westat such that the data entry will not need to be re-opened for correction in Ghana. In the case that scanned images are not yet available, the Study Managers at each site may be asked to confirm data written on the hard-copy forms in order to resolve data discrepancies. Data errors or omissions will be referred by the Study Manager to the Interviewer for correction. The Interviewer will clearly initial and date any corrections to the forms. If a corrected form has already been scanned, the Study Manager will communicate with Westat before re-scanning. If a corrected form has already been entered into data entry and submitted, the Study Manager will contact Westat and request that the form be re-opened. Data entry staff will then be able to make the correction and re-submit the data.

After data entry inconsistencies are reconciled, the data will be programmatically evaluated to identify outlier values, discrepant responses or information, and lack of adherence to questionnaire skip patterns. A description of data issues will be entered into a Data Decision Log, along with the Participant ID, form ID, and date. Unresolved data issues will be sent to the appropriate Ghana study site on a periodic basis for clarification. Upon resolution, the Data Decision Log will be updated with the action to be taken, date, and person who approved the action. The data record will then be updated, if needed.

After data records are edited, they will be added to the cumulative database for that specific form. Comparable data from various forms may be programmatically compared and reviewed for consistency. Data issues will be entered into a Data Decision Log and resolved, as outlined above. Frequencies by data collection site and across sites will be reviewed periodically as a quality control

procedure. Interviewer quality control checks will also be performed by Westat such as reviewing the length of interviews, the percentage of interviews that are complete, partial, or critical questions only, and any comments reported by the interviewers regarding interview quality.